

THE 'All or Nothing' MENTALITY

STUCK...

Mistake, after mistake, after mistake. You pick yourself up again. And again. But still, you fall once more.

It becomes this cycle that has only one end in sight. In big, bolded letters at the very front of your mind, it shouts **'GIVE UP'**. And so, like an easy escape, you do. You give up. You are only left to wonder what you have learnt or what you will do next. You feel empty, don't you?

What if I told you that every time you stumble, just like the time that you received 60% for your exam that you studied so hard for, or that in-class quiz that you barely managed to pass, or the essay that cannot stick in your head no matter what, is really one step closer to your best self?

It is so easy to think ***'if I can't do this, then I can't do anything'***. So you're eventually trapped in the **'All or Nothing'** mentality. However, the mistakes that you make as both a student and a person are not indicators of failure but rather, learning opportunities paving your way to growth

MEET NOVA

My friend, Nova, loves to colour. In fact, she considers herself a professional!



However, one thing about Nova is that she follows a strict technique to avoid colouring out the lines. Nova always perfectly outlines her drawings first then colours in the gaps. Outline. Colour. Outline. Colour. Outline. Col-

Her hand slips. A bright red streak is left slashing her paper as her mind tells her:

'My image is ruined'. 'I should never colour again'. 'I am the worst artist in the world'.

These are the same exact thoughts that run through my head and most likely yours when we can't seem to get something right. From there, we just want to give up.

But Nova realised that restarting her artwork would take longer than trying to find a quick solution to her issue.

Instead, with a few strokes, the red streak became the feature of her artwork. It was special!

GROWING...

Just like Nova, the most talented people around you don't just make mistakes. They do not remain trapped in the 'All or Nothing' mindset. They make an effort to escape, embracing the small setbacks as a chance to learn so that the same mistake won't happen again.

Believe it or not, this can be *YOU!*

HOW YOU CAN ESCAPE THE 'ALL OR NOTHING' MENTALITY

PRACTICE SELF-COMPASSION

It's crucial to be kind to the people around you but don't forget yourself.

Allow yourself to make those mistakes without judgement or negative self-talk.

SHIFT YOUR FOCUS

It should never be **'It's too hard', 'I already suck at this'.**

Rather, focus on accepting your mistakes as you practice positive self-talk e.g. **'With time & hard work, I will be able to achieve this', 'I just need more practice'.**

The way in which you speak to yourself before proceeding with something alters how your brain will think going into the activity. Thus, if you go into something already telling yourself that you can't do it, your brain is ready to do so.

SPEAK TO THE PEOPLE AROUND YOU

A strong support network that recognises the 'All or Nothing' mentality is a barrier to success will assist you in detaching from such.

I promise you that all tutors at DA make mistakes every single day, myself included, and from their personal experience, these mistakes have allowed them to grow into the incredible people they are.

You are not defined by your mistakes.

You are defined by the growth that comes from embracing and learning from them!

SET SMALL GOALS

The harsh reality is that 99% of the time, you will never get things right the first go. So, you must **aim for progress, not perfection.**

BECAUSE AT THE END OF THE DAY,

ALL THE BEST ART COMES FROM COLOURING OUTSIDE THE LINES.